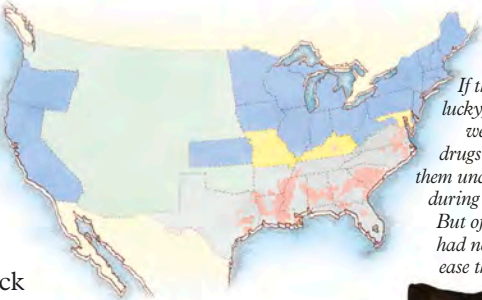




THE AMERICAN CIVIL WAR

In 1861, a civil war started in America between states in the South who owned slaves and states in the North who thought this was wrong. The South tried to break away from the Union to form a separate nation, but the North went to war to prevent this. After four years of bitter fighting, the North won and the South was forced to return to the Union. But the price paid by both sides was terrible. More than 600,000 soldiers died, more than half of them victims of disease, not of battle. When they got sick or were wounded, their treatment was as likely to kill them as cure them. The field hospitals were filthy and the surgeons often poorly trained.



If they were lucky, soldiers were given drugs to make them unconscious during surgery. But often they had nothing to ease the pain.

- Northern states
- Confederate states
- Border states that fought on the Northern side
- Areas with the most slaves
- Other territories



The Confederates

The soldiers of the South, or Confederacy, were given uniforms of gray coats and caps, and blue trousers. When uniforms were in short supply the men wore whatever they could find.